

## Intel Core i7 990x out

Intel has started shipping its six-core Core i7-990x Extreme Edition processor which is clocked at 3.46 GHz and includes 12MB of cache memory

## Google Music coming soon?

According to UK's newspaper Guardian, Google's music service will be launched soon and will be a part of Android Honeycomb

**Bazaar mini**

### GRAPHICS CARDS



#### ASUS GTX 580

Price: ₹37,000



#### ASUS Radeon HD 6970

Price: ₹27,000



#### NVIDIA GTX 560Ti

Price : ₹15,000

### BATTERY CHARGER



#### Choiix Power Fort

Price: ₹3,500

### SPECIFICATIONS

Core Clock ..... 782 MHz  
Video Memory ..... 1536 MB  
Memory Interface ..... 384 bit  
CUDA Cores ..... 512

Core Clock ..... 890 MHz  
Memory ..... 2048 MB  
Memory Interface ..... 256 bit  
Unified Shaders ..... 1536

Core Clock ..... 822 MHz  
Memory Clock ..... 4008 MHz  
Memory Interface ..... 256 bit  
CUDA Cores ..... 384

Power Capacity.... 2700 mAh / 10 Whrs  
Weight: ..... 102 g  
Battery Type..... Lithium-polymer  
Dimension..... 11 x 6.4 x 1.2 cm

### TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

#### Features.....6.5

ASUS GTX 580 is overclocked by 10 MHz and is a triple slot card with two 8-pin power connectors.

#### Performance .....8.5

3D Mark Vantage : 27046; FarCry2 (1080p, 8xAA) : 99 fps; STALKER COP (1080p, 4xAA) : 105 fps. Crysis Warhead (1080p, Very High) : 45fps

#### Build quality .....7.0

One of the bulkiest GTX 580s that we tested. Built sturdily with two fan sections and a heatsink.

#### Value for money.....7.5

At ₹37,000, it is much cheaper than Sparkle GTX 580.

#### Features.....6.5

ASUS HD 6970 comes with a 10MHz overclock and features the Voltage Tweak tool.

#### Performance .....7.0

3D Mark Vantage : 19213; FarCry2 (1080p, 8xAA) : 77 fps; STALKER COP (1080p, 4xAA) : 83 fps. Crysis Warhead (1080p, Very High) : 34fps

#### Build quality .....6.0

Sturdy aluminum build, very similar to the reference AMD HD 6970 card.

#### Value for money.....4.0

At ₹27,000 ASUS' pricing is higher than other HD 6970 cards.

#### Features.....6.0

It's based on the GF-114 architecture with all 8 Stream Multiprocessors activated.

#### Performance .....7.5

3D Mark Vantage : 21046; FarCry2 (1080p, 8xAA) : 81 fps; STALKER COP (1080p, 4xAA) : 76 fps. Crysis Warhead (1080p, Very High) : 32fps

#### Build Quality.....6.0

Sturdy plastic build with a strong fan is placed in the centre of the card.

#### Value for money.....7.0

At ₹15,000, the GTX 560Ti is appropriately priced.

#### Features.....8.0

It comes with a fully loaded travel accessories pack and the device itself sports an LED flashlight.

#### Performance .....7.0

On a single charge we were able to fully charge an iPod Touch 3G followed by an iPhone 3G to three-fourths of the way. Smaller devices would benefit even more.

#### Build quality .....7.0

The device, though surprisingly light, is well built and even ergonomically convenient

#### Value for money .....7.0

Good value considering the kind of audience it is targeted at.

### WE SAY

7.5

ASUS GTX 580 is a great card and the 10 MHz overclock adds a minor boost to the scores, not more than 4-5 per cent. ASUS GTX580 scored higher in COH:TOV, FarCry2 and STALKER Call of Pripyat as compared to Sparkle GTX580. Crysis Warhead performance is similar to Sparkle GTX 580. One of the things that we felt can work against the card is its bulky form factor that occupies three slots which can be problematic for those planning on doing dual GPU SLI. Pricing is about ₹5,000 cheaper than the Sparkle GTX 580 which comes at ₹42,500

6.0

In our performance scores, the ASUS HD6970 performed at par with the XFX HD 6970 in most tests except in FarCry2 and STALKER COP. The 10MHz factory overclock hardly makes any difference in the overall playing experience. Smart Doctor that comes bundled with the card allows easy overclocking of the card as it allows you to tweak the voltages so that the card is stable at higher clock speeds. However, it is considerably slower than GTX 570. We would not recommend a ₹5,000 premium on the 10MHz overclock. Great card if the prices come down.

6.5

This is a very good card for those looking to buy a good performer at an economical price point. It performs better than HD 6950 in most of the tests. As compared to the ZOTAC GTX 560Ti AMP Edition, the stock NVIDIA card pales in comparison as the former is factory overclocked. So for the performance boost, we would recommend the ZOTAC card for its sheer prowess over the stock card in all parameters.

#### ALSO SEE:

- 1) ZOTAC GTX 460 AMP Edition  
September 2010
- 2) Galaxy GTX 460 GC  
November 2010

7.5

The Choiix Power Fort is a battery pack that can charge your devices such as iPhone, iPad, PSP and almost any phone, on the go. It comes with a travel accessories pack that includes a USB car charger, and a wall adapter on which you can clip on the various bundled pins to suit the regional plug points. An ideal companion for globe trotters who constantly find themselves running out of battery on their devices. The device is light and small enough to be pocket-able but considering the various attachments it comes with, this baby will most likely be in your backpack.